

SaaS Subscription Billing and Refund Policy

Overview

This policy document describes the terms, conditions, and procedures governing subscription billing, refund requests, payment disputes, and charge anomalies for the Adsparkx SaaS Platform. Our objective is to deliver transparent, predictable billing while protecting our cloud infrastructure resources and client relations. Subscribers are billed on a recurring monthly or annual cycle, and are subject to the conditions outlined herein. We ask that users review this document carefully before submitting disputes to help speed up processing times. Standard plans automatically renew at the end of each billing cycle unless a cancellation is requested. All payments are processed through Stripe's secure infrastructure, maintaining strict PCI-DSS compliance across all financial interactions.

Symptoms

Billing discrepancies and system anomalies are typically identified by customers when checking their credit card statements or their workspace billing panels. Common symptoms include: observing two identical charge amounts from Adsparkx on the same business day (duplicate charges); seeing a charge continue to appear on your bank statement after initiating a plan cancellation; receiving a 'Failed Transaction' email despite your financial institution authorizing the charge; or seeing a discrepancy between the allocated seat quota on your dashboard and the final invoice total sent to your email. Additionally, customers may notice pending transactions on their banking interface that differ from the final captured amount shown on their account receipt.

Common Causes

Billing issues are generally caused by a few common scenarios. Duplicate charges on bank statements are often temporary authorization holds placed by the payment gateway (Stripe) to check card validity; these are automatically cleared by your bank within 3 to 7 business days. True duplicate charges can occur if a user unintentionally creates multiple accounts or workspaces using different email addresses. Subscription charges continuing after cancellation are usually due to the user not completing the final confirmation step in the cancellation UI. Discrepancies in invoice totals can occur when seats are added mid-cycle, resulting in prorated charges on the next invoice. Multi-currency translation delays can also lead to small differences on card statements.

Troubleshooting Steps

Before contacting support to dispute a billing charge, please complete the following preliminary checks: 1. Check the Invoice History: Log in to your Adsparkx dashboard, navigate to Settings > Billing, and download the latest PDF invoices. Compare the invoice items with your credit card statement. 2. Confirm Account Ownership: If you see charges you do not recognize, check if other team members or departments have registered under a corporate card. 3. Review Plan Changes: Verify if any users added new team seats or upgraded the API usage tier during the billing cycle. 4. Bank Verification: Contact your card provider to confirm whether the charge is a finalized settlement or a temporary authorization hold. 5. Check Multiple Profiles: Search your emails for secondary accounts that might have active subscriptions.

Resolution

Upon verifying the details, the following resolutions can be applied: Eligible refunds for monthly subscriptions will be credited to the original payment method. The standard processing timeline for a refund is 5 to 10 business days, depending on your bank's policies. If a duplicate charge occurred due to an administrative error, the duplicate amount will be reversed instantly, and you will receive an automated email receipt confirming the reversal. For prorated adjustments, credit notes will be issued and applied automatically to reduce the balance of your next billing statement. Under no circumstances will refunds be processed to a different credit card to prevent laundering attempts and gateway compliance violations.

Best Practices

To prevent billing discrepancies and payment issues, we recommend adhering to these guidelines: Always use a single centralized corporate account for team subscriptions rather than allowing individuals to buy separate workspace plans on personal cards. Review your active team seat allocations monthly and remove inactive members before the billing cycle renews. Keep your primary credit card details updated in the dashboard to avoid failed transaction warnings and account suspensions. If your organization requires corporate invoicing (Purchase Orders), contact our team before purchasing to set up invoicing terms. Enable billing notifications in Settings so your accounting department receives invoice copies automatically.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What is the refund eligibility window for monthly plans? A: You are eligible for a full refund if you request it within 7 days of the transaction date, and your workspace's API usage during that billing period is below 10% of the active tier quota. Q: Can I get a refund for an annual subscription? A: Annual plan refunds are prorated. We will calculate the usage cost under standard monthly rates for the active months, and refund the remaining balance to your card.

Q: What happens if a transaction fails? A: The gateway retries the card 3 times over 14 days. If all attempts fail, the workspace will be temporarily suspended, and access to API endpoints will be restricted. Q: Why does a refund take 10 business days to clear? A: While Adsparkx processes refunds immediately, card networks and individual banks require additional processing time to route funds back into cardholders' credit balances.

Escalation Conditions

Billing disputes require immediate redirection to a human billing specialist under the following conditions: 1. Refund requests for amounts exceeding \$500. 2. Duplicate charges that have remained on the customer's bank statement for more than 7 business days. 3. Accidental charges on workspaces belonging to non-profit or educational accounts. 4. Escalation of chargeback alerts or formal disputes received from merchant card processors. 5. Direct threats of legal action or reports referencing regulatory bodies. To escalate, the representative must compile the handoff ticket with the associated transaction IDs, the first and last name of the cardholder, and the email address mapped to the billing workspace.

Additional Notes

Please note that filing a direct chargeback dispute with your credit card issuer instead of contacting Adsparkx support will cause Stripe to automatically suspend the target account and associated API services indefinitely pending investigation. We strongly recommend resolving payment disputes directly with our support team to prevent service suspension. Adsparkx reserves the right to deny refund claims to accounts demonstrating patterns of repeated subscription cycle abuse.